

Investment and Financial Decision-Making

投资与金融决策

GRADE 9 | SEMESTER 1, 2026-27

This course helps students understand how money grows, how financial markets work, and how to make thoughtful decisions when outcomes are uncertain. Through practical examples and real company evidence, students develop financial knowledge alongside mathematical reasoning, critical thinking and teamwork.

What students will learn

- 01 Understand investment returns.** Calculate gains and income, explain compound growth, and consider how inflation and fees affect results.
- 02 Balance goals and risk.** Compare savings, bonds, shares and funds, and explain why different choices suit different needs and time horizons.
- 03 Build an investment portfolio.** Decide how to spread money across investments and understand the benefits and limits of diversification.
- 04 Investigate markets and companies.** Examine how trades work, why prices change, and what company profits, cash flow and debt can reveal.
- 05 Evaluate decisions.** Question performance claims, recognise emotional biases, and support recommendations with evidence while acknowledging uncertainty.

How lessons work

Lessons are taught primarily in English, with Chinese support for key concepts and financial vocabulary. Students work through teacher demonstrations, calculations, discussions and independent tasks. They are encouraged to explain their reasoning, check assumptions and consider alternative conclusions.

The Stock Market Game

Students work in teams of three to manage a simulated portfolio using virtual money. Following classroom instruction, they will research investments, agree on decisions, record their reasons and review outcomes. **No real investment money is required.**

How learning is checked

Learning is checked through short quizzes, calculations, written explanations and case studies. The planned final task asks students to develop and defend an investment recommendation, drawing together their understanding of goals, evidence, risk and trade-offs.

The course aims to build lasting financial judgement: asking informed questions, assessing evidence carefully and making responsible decisions.